

AFT2

Accreditation Audit

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

During an accreditation survey at a 300-bed hospital that recently opened a new parking garage, a surveyor picks a patient on the cardiac unit. She follows the patient's care from emergency department admission through lab, pharmacy and discharge planning, interviewing staff and reviewing records at each stop. Which survey method is this?

- A. A root cause analysis.
- B. A chart audit.
- C. A mock survey.
- D. An individual patient tracer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A primary-care clinic with eight providers and a new electronic health record wants to reduce missed appointments. It predicted that text reminders would cut no-shows by a third, then tested them with one provider's patients for two weeks and collected the no-show data. What is the next step in the PDSA cycle?

- A. Study: compare the results with the prediction.
- B. Plan: redesign the test before looking at the results.
- C. Do: run the same test again.
- D. Act: roll the reminders out to all providers now.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In the Act phase of a PDSA cycle, what does the team do?

- A. Always roll the change out to the whole organization.
- B. Collect data while the test runs.
- C. Compare results with the prediction.
- D. Adopt, adapt or abandon the change based on what was learned.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A patient received the wrong medication after two drugs with similar names were stored side by side in an automated cabinet. The nurse involved has 20 years of experience and a spotless record. The hospital just finished a \$5 million renovation. What should the root cause analysis focus on?

- A. Nothing further, since an experienced nurse's error must be a fluke.
- B. Making sure human error never happens again.
- C. The storage, labeling and verification processes that allowed the mix-up.
- D. Whether the nurse should be disciplined.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

On a 32-bed surgical unit that won a hospital quality award last year, a nurse skipped barcode scanning before giving a medication because she was rushed. Several coworkers take the same shortcut, and she believed the risk was low. The patient was not harmed. Under a just culture, what is the right response?

- A. No response, because the patient was not harmed.
- B. Terminate her for reckless conduct.
- C. Console her, because it was an honest slip.
- D. Coach the nurse and fix the conditions that make the shortcut common.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Under a just culture, which behavior calls for disciplinary action?

- A. An honest slip, such as picking up the wrong vial.
- B. Any error that causes harm.
- C. Knowingly working a shift while impaired.
- D. A shortcut many coworkers take, believing it is safe.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A hospital will roll out a new smart infusion-pump system, which cost \$1.8 million, across 12 nursing units next quarter. The risk manager, who holds a nursing degree, wants to find how the new process could fail and fix weaknesses before any patient is harmed. Which tool fits?

- A. Failure mode and effects analysis (FMEA).
- B. A patient tracer.
- C. Root cause analysis (RCA).
- D. A review of past incident reports.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient suffered serious harm after an equipment failure last week. Which tool should the hospital use now?

- A. No analysis is needed if the patient recovers.
- B. Root cause analysis.
- C. FMEA.
- D. A Pareto chart of all incidents this year.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A 180-bed hospital in Ohio that opened a cancer center last year is accredited by an accrediting organization that CMS has approved. The hospital's CEO asks what “deemed status” means for the hospital. What is the accurate answer?

- A. The hospital is deemed to meet Medicare's Conditions of Participation through its accreditation.
- B. The hospital receives higher Medicare payment rates.
- C. Deemed status is granted by the state licensing board.
- D. The hospital is exempt from all federal and state health laws.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

An accreditation survey found that 3 of 10 sampled patient records lacked a documented pain reassessment. The chief nursing officer has been in her role for six months. The hospital must show it has corrected the problem. What is the strongest response?

- A.** Hold one education session and report it as complete.
- B.** Find the cause, fix the process (for example, an EHR prompt), and audit records over several months to show sustained compliance.
- C.** Complete the documentation in the three records.
- D.** Promise 100% compliance from now on.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A hospital with 12 cardiologists and an 18% heart-failure readmission rate tracks the percentage of heart-failure patients who receive written discharge instructions. In Donabedian's model, what kind of measure is this?

- A.** Structure.
- B.** Process.
- C.** Input.
- D.** Outcome, like the readmission rate.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is a structure measure in Donabedian's model?

- A.** Percentage of heart-attack patients given aspirin on arrival.
- B.** 30-day mortality after heart attack.
- C.** The nurse-to-patient staffing ratio.
- D.** Number of surveys a hospital passes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

During an accreditation survey at a ~~300-bed hospital that recently opened a new parking garage~~, a surveyor picks a patient on the cardiac unit. She follows the patient's care from emergency department admission through lab, pharmacy and discharge planning, interviewing staff and reviewing records at each stop. Which survey method is this?

Target word: survey method **Decides:** Following one patient's care across departments.

A	Confusion set	RCA investigates an adverse event; no event is described.
B	Dropped element	Drops the interviews and direct observation across departments.
C	Adjacent category	A mock survey is the hospital's own practice run, not the accreditor's survey.
D	Correct	Tracing one patient's care through the system is the tracer method.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A primary-care clinic ~~with eight providers and a new electronic health record~~ wants to reduce missed appointments. It predicted that text reminders would cut no-shows by a third, then tested them with one provider's patients for two weeks and collected the no-show data. What is the next step in the PDSA cycle?

Target word: next PDSA step **Decides:** Plan and Do are complete; results have not been compared with the prediction.

A	Correct	Study follows Do and tells the team what the test showed.
B	Inverted operation	Goes back to Plan without learning from the data collected.
C	Adjacent category	Repeating Do adds data but skips learning from the first test.
D	Dropped element	Skips Study; the team does not yet know if the test worked.

3. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

In the Act phase of a PDSA cycle, what does the team do?

Target word: Act phase **Decides:** Act turns learning into a decision.

A	Absolute language	Act may adapt or abandon the change as well.
B	Confusion set	That happens in Do.
C	Adjacent category	That is Study.
D	Correct	Act decides what to do next with the change.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A patient received the wrong medication after two drugs with similar names were stored side by side in an automated cabinet. The nurse involved has 20 years of experience and a spotless record. ~~The hospital just finished a \$5-million renovation.~~ What should the root cause analysis focus on?

Target word: focus of the RCA **Decides:** Look-alike drugs stored together is a system weakness.

A	Camouflage	Answers the nurse's record; the system weakness remains.
B	Absolute language	Error cannot be eliminated; systems are designed to catch it.
C	Correct	RCA targets system causes that can be fixed.
D	Confusion set	Blame is not the purpose of an RCA.

5. Answer D Concept 4

On a 32-bed surgical unit that won a hospital quality award last year, a nurse skipped barcode scanning before giving a medication because she was rushed. Several coworkers take the same shortcut, and she believed the risk was low. The patient was not harmed. Under a just culture, what is the right response?

Target word: response to the behavior **Decides:** A chosen shortcut whose risk she did not see as significant: at-risk behavior.

A	Dropped element	Just culture judges the behavior, not the outcome.
B	Confusion set	Reckless means consciously disregarding a substantial risk; she believed the risk was low.
C	Adjacent category	A slip is unintended; she chose the shortcut.
D	Correct	At-risk behavior calls for coaching and removing the incentives to drift.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

Under a just culture, which behavior calls for disciplinary action?

Target word: reckless behavior **Decides:** Conscious disregard of a substantial, unjustifiable risk.

A	Inverted operation	Human error is consoled, the opposite response.
B	Dropped element	Drops the behavior and judges only the outcome.
C	Correct	Consciously disregarding a serious risk is reckless.
D	Adjacent category	At-risk behavior is coached.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A hospital will roll out a new smart infusion-pump system, which cost \$1.8 million, across 12 nursing units next quarter. The risk manager, who holds a nursing degree, wants to find how the new process could fail and fix weaknesses before any patient is harmed. Which tool fits?

Target word: proactive tool **Decides:** The process is new and nothing has gone wrong yet.

A	Correct	FMEA identifies potential failures before they occur.
B	Confusion set	Tracers examine care already being delivered.
C	Inverted operation	RCA is reactive, used after an event.
D	Adjacent category	There is no history for a system not yet in use.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A patient suffered serious harm after an equipment failure last week. Which tool should the hospital use now?

Target word: reactive tool **Decides:** The event has already happened.

A	Dropped element	Drops the system weakness that caused serious harm.
B	Correct	RCA investigates why an event that already occurred happened.
C	Inverted operation	FMEA is proactive, before failures occur.
D	Adjacent category	Useful for patterns, but not to find this event's causes.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A ~~180-bed hospital in Ohio that opened a cancer center last year~~ is accredited by an accrediting organization that CMS has approved. The hospital's CEO asks what "deemed status" means for the hospital. What is the accurate answer?

Target word: meaning of deemed status **Decides:** Accreditation by a CMS-approved body.

A	Correct	Deemed status substitutes accreditation for routine certification surveys.
B	Confusion set	Deemed status concerns participation, not payment rates.
C	Adjacent category	The status comes through CMS-approved accreditation, not state licensing.
D	Absolute language	Other laws and state licensing still apply.

10. Answer B Concept 7

An accreditation survey found that 3 of 10 sampled patient records lacked a documented pain reassessment. ~~The chief nursing officer has been in her role for six months.~~ The hospital must show it has corrected the problem. What is the strongest response?

Target word: strongest corrective action **Decides:** A sampled finding points to a process gap.

A	Adjacent category	Education alone, without measurement, does not show sustained change.
B	Correct	Fixes the system and proves the fix lasts.
C	Dropped element	Fixes only the sample; the process gap remains.
D	Absolute language	A promise is not evidence.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A hospital ~~with 12 cardiologists and an 18% heart failure readmission rate~~ tracks the percentage of heart-failure patients who receive written discharge instructions. In Donabedian's model, what kind of measure is this?

Target word: measure type **Decides:** Giving instructions is something done for the patient.

A	Adjacent category	Structure is the setting and resources, such as staffing.
B	Correct	Whether a care step is performed is a process measure.
C	Confusion set	Not a Donabedian category.
D	Camouflage	Answers the readmission detail; the tracked measure is a care step.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

Which is a structure measure in Donabedian's model?

Target word: a structure measure **Decides:** Structure = resources and setting.

A	Adjacent category	A process measure.
B	Inverted operation	An outcome, the opposite end of the model.
C	Correct	Staffing is a resource of the care setting.
D	Confusion set	Accreditation results are not a Donabedian category.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	11	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Tracer methodology	Surveyors follow an actual patient's care across departments, interviewing staff and checking records at each stop, to see how systems work together.	Thinking an accreditation survey is only a review of documents.	A surveyor following one patient's path through the organization.
2	PDSA cycle	Plan a small test with a prediction, Do it, Study the results against the prediction, then Act: adopt, adapt or abandon.	Skipping Study and rolling a test out everywhere.	A small test just finished and a question about the next step.
3	Root cause analysis	An RCA after a serious event looks for the system and process causes that allowed the error, not for someone to blame.	Stopping at the individual who made the error.	An adverse event plus details about the person involved.
4	Just culture	Console human error, coach at-risk behavior (a drifted shortcut), and discipline reckless behavior (conscious disregard of a substantial risk), regardless of outcome.	Judging by outcome, or punishing every error.	Whether the person chose the shortcut, knew the risk, and whether harm occurred.
5	FMEA vs. RCA	Failure mode and effects analysis is proactive, before harm; root cause analysis is reactive, after an event.	Using RCA to evaluate a process that has not failed yet.	Whether the process is new and untested or an event has already happened.
6	Deemed status	A hospital accredited by a CMS-approved accrediting organization is deemed to meet Medicare Conditions of Participation.	Believing accreditation exempts the hospital from other laws or is granted by the state.	Accreditation linked to Medicare participation.
7	Sustainable corrective action	A strong response to a survey finding fixes the process cause and measures compliance over time to show it is sustained.	Fixing only the sampled records or relying on one-time education.	A finding based on a sample and a question about the best response.
8	Donabedian's structure, process, outcome	Structure is the setting and resources, process is what is done for patients, and outcome is the effect on patients' health.	Calling any quality measure an outcome.	A single quality measure to classify.

Course scope (public description): Accreditation Audit covers regulatory audits, resource assessment, quality improvement, patient care improvement, organization plans, risk management, effective interaction, and compliance as evidenced during an accreditation audit.